

MAYU HARADA (she/her)

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LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/in/mayu-harada

Education

Kyoto University, Kyoto, Japan / Apr 2023 — Mar 2027 (expected)

Bachelor of Agriculture, Applied Life Sciences, Grade: GPA **3.92**/4.00 (158 credits)

Coursework: Microbiology, Biochemistry, Genetics, Chemical Biology, Organic Chemistry, Statistics, Forestry, French

Yamaguchi Prefectural Ube High School, Yamaguchi, Japan / Apr 8, 2020 — Mar 1, 2023

High School Diploma, Grade: **5.00**/5.00 (92 credits)

Katabami Award: Selected as one of the three representatives among 233 students based on academic performance

Research Experience

YURIMOTO lab, Kyoto University, Kyoto, Japan / Apr 2026 — Present (Hiroya Yurimoto)

- Project: “Assessment of Methane Oxidation and C1 Metabolism in Non-Methanotrophic Actinomycetes”
- Evaluating short-chain alkane utilization and methane oxidation activity in approximately 20 actinomycete strains, and identifying optimal candidates for co-culture production systems with methylotrophic bacteria

Nakatani ARIP, University of California Davis, Davis, California, US / Jan 2026 — Apr 2026 (Soichiro Yamada)

- Project: “Structural analysis of intrinsically disordered proteins involved in cellular tension response”
- Analyzed binding regions between IDPs and keratin filaments based on multiple sequence alignment, followed by protein expression and binding assays

KURIHARA lab, Kyoto University, Kyoto, Japan / Aug 2025 — Jan 2026 (Tatsuo Kurihara, Jun Kawamoto)

- Project: “Quantitative and qualitative analysis of microbial membrane vesicle production
- Screened of high EMV-producing microorganisms using ultracentrifugation, nanoparticle tracking analysis, and fluorescent dyes, with subsequent biochemical characterization

Nakatani RIES, Georgia Institute of Technology, Georgia, US / Aug 2025 — Sep 2025 (Amanda Stockton)

- Project: “Optimizing Sampling Strategies for Astrobiology Using Martian-analogue Field Sites”
- Developed and validated a protocol quantify bioavailable phosphate from ultra-low-biomass samples
- Performed 16S rRNA amplicon analysis to model associations between community composition and environmental factors

iGEM (International Genetically Engineered Machine) Kyoto, Kyoto University, Kyoto, Japan / Nov 2023 — Oct 2024

- Project: “Designing and Platforming a Cell-free Biosensor of Soil Nitrogen”
- Devised a project and experimental protocols as a project leader
- Discussed with researchers and stakeholders, made presentations, wrote articles as a Human Practices leader
- Awarded Gold Medal, Best Agriculture Project Nominate, Best Hardware Nominate at 2024 iGEM Grand Jamboree in Paris, France / Oct 2024

UESUGI lab, Kyoto University, Kyoto, Japan / Sep 2023 (Motonari Uesugi)

- Project: “Refolding of Denatured Proteins by Artificial Chaperons”
- Measured fluorescence absorbance recovery of samples with proteins denatured by potential artificial chaperons at different concentrations to determine the optimal concentration ratio of chemicals

Super Science High School, Yamaguchi University, Yamaguchi, Japan / Apr 2021 — Aug 2022 (Makoto Yoshimoto)

- Project: “Explore Natural Surfactants to Destabilize Liposomes and Quantify the Effects”
- Participated in the National SSH competition as a representative of the high school / Aug 2022
- Awarded Excellence Award at Student Presentation in Society for Chemical Engineers / Mar 2022

Global Science Campus, Prefectural University of Hiroshima, Hiroshima, Japan / Dec 2020 — Mar 2022 (Shinjiro Ogita)

- Project: “Humidity Control Ability of Tillandsia Plant”
- Awarded Excellence Award (5-12th place in Japan) at GSC National Competition / Oct 2021

International Experience

Full-year Exchange Program, The University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada / Sep 2024 — Apr 2025

- Coursework: Microbiology, Biochemistry, Cell Biology, Soil Science, Atmospheric Environments, Statistics (Grade: 87.9/100, 21 credits)

Spring School, National Taiwan University, Taipei, Taiwan / Mar 2024

- Developed skills to handle basic conversations and deliver a presentation in Mandarin
- Learned the history, culture, politics of Taiwan in English (Grade: A)

Kyoto Consortium for Japanese Studies, Kyoto, Japan / Sep 2023 — Dec 2023

- Engaged in discussions and presentations on the environmental policies with students from American universities in “Japan and East Asian Regional Environmental Issues” course (Grade: A+)
- Explored practical policy applications through field trips and interactions with experts and classmates

Work Experience

Research Institute for Humanity and Nature, Kyoto, Japan / Aug 2025 — Present (Kentaro Hayashi, Keisuke Koba)

- Organizing a youth event at the 10th International Nitrogen Conference
- Author of the Japan Nitrogen Assessment

Kyoto Summer Program 2024, Kyoto, Japan / Apr 2024 — Aug 2024

- Designed discussion themes and supported facilitators to ensure smooth and productive sessions
- Recruited participants through outreach and promotional activities
- Acted as the field trip coordinator, negotiating with companies and university institutions, and served as a tour guide during the event

Scholarships & Awards

Toyota Riken Scholarship / Jul 2026 — Present / 10,000,000 JPY (61,600 USD) per year

Gyomu Super Japan Dream Foundation Scholarship / Sep 2024 — Apr 2025 / 1,850,000 JPY (11,400 USD)

Keyence Foundation Scholarship / Jul 2024 / 300,000 JPY (1,850 USD)

Skills & Certifications

Language: Japanese, English (TOEFL iBT: 100/120), French (Test in Practical French Proficiency: Grade 3), Korean